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Blogging in India is still at its nascent stage. The amount of advertising happening online is also not high across Web sites. Rediff and Yahoo! are among the few major names in online advertising. Besides, how many serious Indian blogs do you know of? I, myself, am familiar with just eight or ten. And even these blogs have a diverse audience.

Bloggers are an intelligent lot who don't surf the Internet for information alone. It's possible that bloggers may find advertising to be some kind of intrusion on their space. So, we need to understand the pulse of the audience before we advertise.

Also, the kind of advertisements made for blogs will have to be very interesting; conventional ads may not appeal to the visitors or bloggers themselves. The ad should be of such a quality that it should be capable of turning the discussion on the blog to the advert itself. Now that's a real challenge! Ad networks in India also don't have a lot of blogs within the network, and therefore there is a problem in terms of the supply of contacts in this area.

I am sure the option of blogs holds a lot of promise, but I would personally be more interested in using blogs as an initial step in any ad campaign, and then continuing with the regular media that are currently in use.

ANYONE?



Anish Sood
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Advertising on blogs in India is not popular at all. I have yet to see private companies and multinationals approach bloggers individually. The only advertising that's popular is Google's AdSense—a unique programme that's caught the eye of the blogger.

I don't have any ads on my blog since I don't need any funds. I gave up the idea as I felt the ads would clutter the interface of my blog, which I wanted to keep slick and clean. However, the only option I had earlier was AdSense. If I receive an individual offer again, I will certainly consider it.

Blogging is newer than other forms of media, and yet has picked up very fast. When you have blogs with about three to five thousand readers per month, it makes sense to advertise. I feel advertising on blogs is the cheapest method of advertising to a specific audience. Pay bloggers even Rs 1,000 a month, and they will gratefully put up your ad.

It's a good medium for advertising companies to exploit, but sadly, they are yet to get hold of it. Advertising on blogs is extremely lucrative, as readers begin to trust a blogger.



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Rohit Gupta
Blogger (www.desimediabitch.blogspot.com)

India has 1.7 per cent Internet penetration, so potentially 18 million bloggers, but in reality there are a few thousand blogs so far. Advertising on blogs is still based on automatic services. However, the potential of blog readership is far more than most leading newspapers.

My blog has Google AdSense and Amazon referrals. The software selects what ads to display based on the blog content, for instance C*S*F (Chiens Sans Frontiers): <http://desimediabitch.blogspot.com>. We are giving away our AdSense earnings as cash for blogging. Being inexpensive, blogs are turning to be attractive for advertisers, and, you pay only if someone clicks on your ad, so your budget is never wasted on what eyeballs the blogger 'claims' to attract. Each and every cent spent is accounted for. Can a print or outdoor ad offer such an honest deal?

Blogs hold potential for future marketing, as product advertisers can communicate directly with customers, bypassing middlemen. Word-of-mouth and other direct media also come into play. A Google ad can come up anywhere on any blog, based on Google's automatic algorithm that selects the ads for bloggers who subscribe to its revenue programme. As time passes, the accuracy of this target-practice becomes more and more efficient.

As told to Preethi Chamikutty (preethi_chamikutty@thinkdigit.com)